

黒幕令嬢

悪役令嬢に転生したので、
黒幕として生きていきます

EPISODE

08

The Choice Her Family Made

彼女の家族が下した選択





ANNUAL
CULTURE FESTIVAL...
A CELEBRATION OF
OUR HISTORY.

EVERY YEAR,
I MAKE SURE OUR
RECORDS ARE
PERFECT.



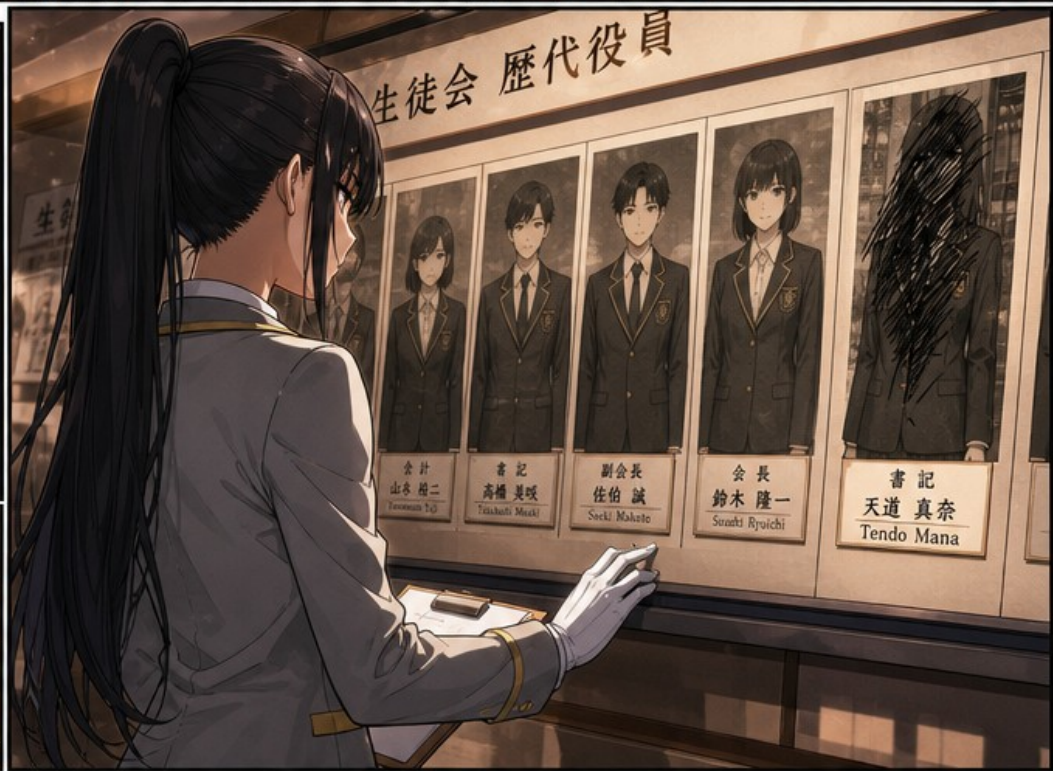
THE STUDENT
COUNCIL HAS
UPHELD TENDO
ACADEMY'S
TRADITIONS
FOR GENERATIONS.

IT'S MY DUTY
TO PROTECT
THAT LEGACY.



TEN-
DO...?

書記
天道 真奈
Tendo Mana



生徒会 歴代役員

会計
山本 裕二
Yamamoto Yūji

書記
高橋 美咲
Takahashi Maki

副会長
佐伯 誠
Saeki Makoto

会長
鈴木 隆一
Suzuki Ryoichi

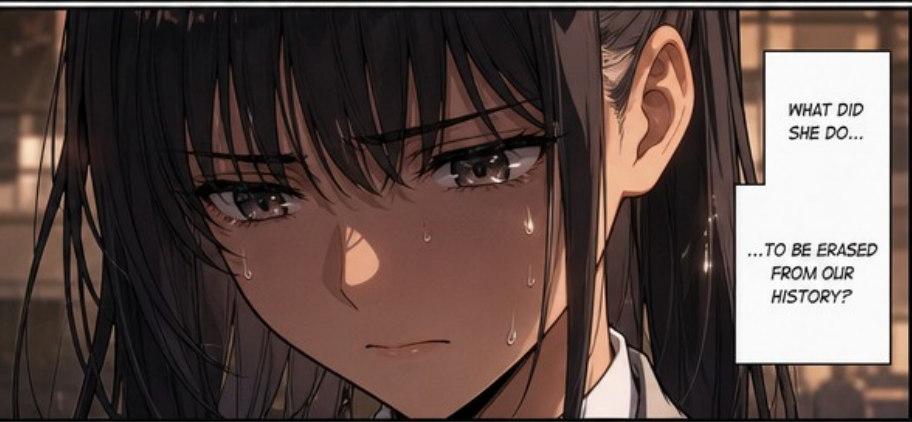
書記
天道 真奈
Tendo Mana



THIS ISN'T
AN ACCIDENT.

THIS WAS
DELIBERATE.

WHY
IS HER FACE
GONE?



WHAT DID
SHE DO...

...TO BE ERASED
FROM OUR
HISTORY?



1

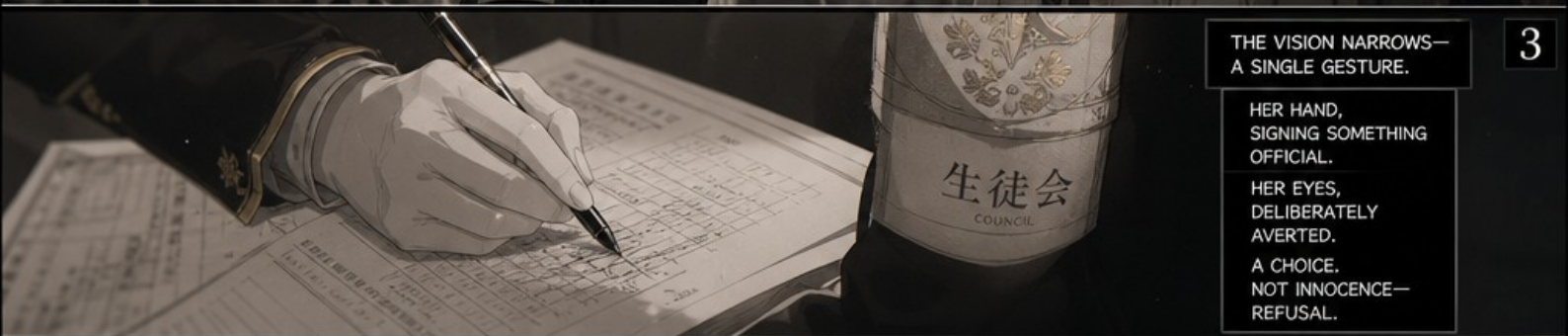
REIKA
TENDO18 | STUDENT COUNCIL
VICE PRESIDENT

THE VISION RESOLVES—
MY GREAT-GRANDMOTHER.
YOUNG. IN THIS EXACT
ROLE. IN THIS EXACT
GYMNASIUM.
DECADES EARLIER.

BESIDE HER—
A WOMAN I DON'T KNOW.
HER FACE—
THAT EXPRESSION—
BETRAYAL.



2



THE VISION NARROWS—
A SINGLE GESTURE.

HER HAND,
SIGNING SOMETHING
OFFICIAL.

HER EYES,
DELIBERATELY
AVERTED.

A CHOICE.
NOT INNOCENCE—
REFUSAL.

3

I GASP BACK TO
THE PRESENT.

THE SCRATCHED-OUT
FACE ISN'T VANDALISM.

IT'S A DECISION.
SOMEONE TRYING—
BADLY—to ERASE
EVIDENCE OF SOMETHING
THEY COULDN'T
LIVE WITH REMEMBERING.



4

KAI MORI
17

Arrives to help with
festival setup.

Finds REIKA still
standing before
the photograph.

Visibly
shaken.

He follows
her gaze to the
scratched-out face.

And without
deliberately
trying—

—his gift catches
a present-truth
thread.

Running from the
photograph
forward through
the decades...

1898

2024

1947

1975

1999

...to someone
alive today.

Present at the
festival right now.

A subjective-POV
blue grid traces
a faint line—

From the
photograph...

Shirakawa Academy Festival – Staff Roster

1	Advisor	K. Watanabe
2	Teacher	M. Hasegawa
3	Teacher	S. Fujimoto
4	Teacher Aide	A. Tendo
5	Teacher	T. Nakajima
6	Nurse	Y. Sakurai
7	Librarian	R. Komatsu

—to a name on
the current staff
roster.

A teacher's aide.

Mid-thirties.

Descended—

KAI realises
with cold clarity.

He does not yet
know how
directly.

He only knows—

The family
REIKIA'S
great-grandmother
wronged—

did not
disappear.

It has been
walking these
halls.

Unknowing.

This entire
time.

REIKA AND KAI
FOUND THE SHAPE.
THEY TOLD ME.

NOW IT'S
A QUESTION
WITH FOUR
ANSWERS.

SURFACE IT

TRUTH FOR NOW.
CHAOS WITHOUT END.

BURY IT

PEACE FOR NOW.
A LIE THAT ROOTS DEEP.

TELL ONLY THE DESCENDANT

KNOWLEDGE WITH A PRICE.
A FUTURE WEIGHTED
BEFORE IT BEGINS.

EACH PATH
A CONSEQUENCE.
EACH CONSEQUENCE
A WEIGHT.

NONE ARE CLEAN.
NONE ARE SAFE.

TELL NO ONE

SILENCE AS PROTECTION.
A CANCER IN THE DARK.

MY GIFT SHOWS ME
THE FUTURE.

IT DOESN'T TELL ME
WHAT SHOULD BE DONE.

IT SHOWS ME
WHAT WILL HAPPEN.

AND LEAVES
THE CHOICE

TO THE PART
OF ME THAT
WAS NEVER
BUILT FOR
THIS KIND OF
QUESTION.

I WISH I COULD
UNREAD THIS.

I CAN'T
FIND THE
SAFE ONE.

THERE
ISN'T ONE.

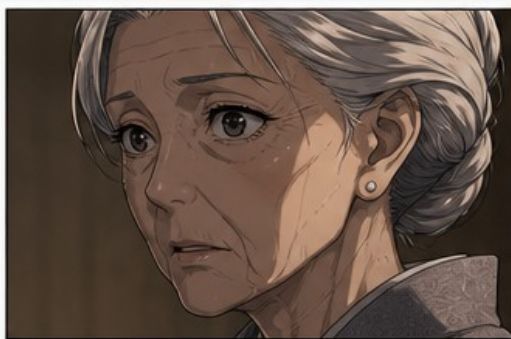
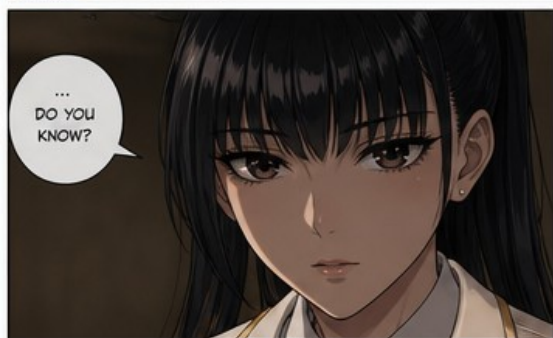
MINUTES LATER.

THE DISTANT SOUND
OF BASKETBALLS.

SHOUTS.

NORMAL,
ORDINARY.

AND I'M THE ONLY ONE
SEEING FOUR DIFFERENT
KINDS OF COLLAPSE.





FOR THE FIRST TIME, I WILL TELL YOU THE FULL AND SPECIFIC SHAPE OF WHAT YOUR GREAT-GRANDMOTHER DID. NOT MERELY COMPLICITY IN THE TÔMEI KIKAN'S DESTRUCTION...

BUT A SINGLE, PARTICULAR CHOICE, DECADES AGO, THAT PROTECTED THE TENDO FAMILY'S STANDING.



WE ALLOWED AN INNOCENT COLLEAGUE, A BRILLIANT RESEARCHER WHO HAD DONE NOTHING WRONG, TO BE BLAMED.

HIS NAME WAS AKIYAMA REN.



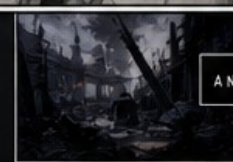
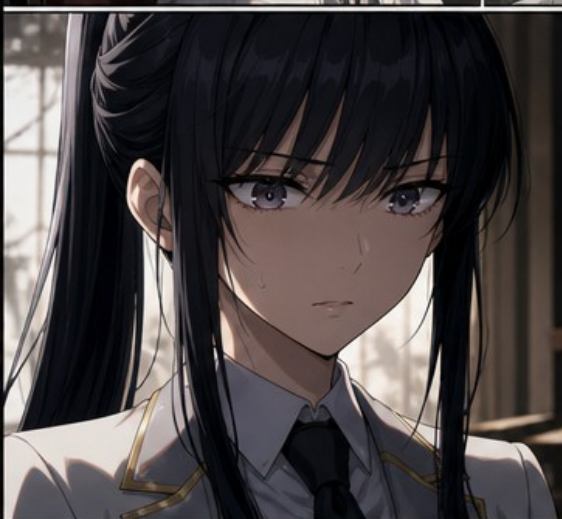
HE WAS SILENCED. ERASED. HIS RESEARCH STOLEN. HIS REPUTATION DESTROYED.

HE DIED BELIEVING HE WAS A TRAITOR TO EVERYTHING HE HAD DEDICATED HIS LIFE TO.



HE LEFT BEHIND A WIFE. A DAUGHTER WHO WAS SIX.

THEY HAVE LIVED FOR GENERATIONS WITH A WOUND WE CAUSED AND NEVER ACKNOWLEDGED.



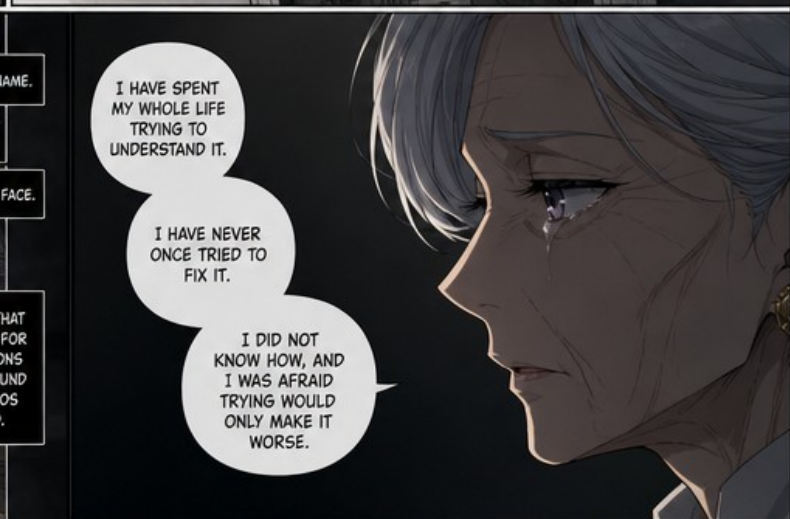
A NAME.



A FACE.



A FAMILY THAT HAS LIVED FOR GENERATIONS WITH A WOUND THE TENDOS CAUSED.



I HAVE SPENT MY WHOLE LIFE TRYING TO UNDERSTAND IT.

I HAVE NEVER ONCE TRIED TO FIX IT.

I DID NOT KNOW HOW, AND I WAS AFRAID TRYING WOULD ONLY MAKE IT WORSE.



TENDO FAMILY HOME
11:47 PM

She has carried this
question for decades.

Whether anyone survived.

Whether anyone alive
today carries what was
done to them.

天道家



TENDO

She does not stop me.

Because she has wanted
someone to ask.

The name is there.

Faded ink.

Same family.

中尾 淳

中村文男

中村幸子

横田重雄 (89, 4498 2-1-8 18 4-7-4)

楠二雄 永渡水斗雄 (89, 4498 2-1-8 18 4-7-4)

中村澄子 永渡水斗雄 (03) 3333277-8846

The name KAI traced
at the festival.

Nakamura...

Not a descendant somewhere.

Not an abstraction.

A person.

Alive.

Walking the same corridors
I walk every day.

Nakamura-sensei.

She does not know.
She cannot know.

What my family
did to hers.

What my family
made her family
carry.

The connection
is complete.
The debt is real.
The silence ends
with me.

EPISODE 7
TAUGHT ME
SOMETHING
I'LL NEVER
FORGET.

A WHOLE TRUTH,
HOWEVER PAINFUL,
HEALS RATHER
THAN HARMS.

I LIVED IT.

REIKA.

YOU HAVE TO
TELL HIM.

ALL OF IT.

SOME TRUTHS
DON'T JUST
SET YOU FREE.

THEY SET
EVERYONE
AROUND YOU
FREE, TOO.

YOU'RE
CARRYING THIS
ALONE...

AND THAT'S
EXACTLY WHY
YOU NEED TO
STOP.

NAKAMURA-
SENSEI
DESERVES
THE TRUTH.

NOT A
VERSION.

NOT A
PROTECTION.

YOU THINK
YOU UNDERSTAND
WHAT IT MEANS
TO TELL
EVERYTHING.

BUT YOU DON'T.

I WAS
TERRIFIED
WHEN I FOUND
OUT ABOUT
MY OWN
FAMILY.

BUT YOU
KNOW WHAT?

THEY TOLD ME.
THE PEOPLE
WHO LOVED ME
ENOUGH TO
BE HONEST.

AND IT DIDN'T
DESTROY ME.

IT MADE ME
WHOLE.

THAT'S
BECAUSE
YOU WERE
LOVED.

YOU WERE
PREPARED.

YOU WERE
PROTECTED.

REIKA...
THIS ISN'T
ABOUT YOU
ANYMORE.

THIS IS
ABOUT HIM.

HE HAS A
RIGHT TO
KNOW.

IT'S TIME YOU
RESPECTED
THAT.

YOU THINK
TRUTH IS
A WEAPON
THAT CUTS
BONDS.

SOMETIMES,
IT'S A BLADE
THAT CUTS
THE PERSON
HOLDING IT.

I WON'T
LET YOU
KEEP LIVING
A LIE FOR
MY SAKE.

OR HIS.

YOU OWE
HIM THE
COURTESY OF
THE WHOLE
TRUTH.

NOT JUST
THE PART
THAT'S EASY.

MY LESSON
DOES NOT
TRANSFER.

NAKAMURA-
SENSEI'S
STABLE.

UNAWARE.

AND HE WOULD
BE SHATTERED.

BY AN
INHERITANCE
I NEVER
ASKED FOR.

IN A WAY
YOU...

RECEIVING
YOURS...

WERE NOT.

SORA MINABE, 16.

HE WAS SUMMONED
BY NEITHER OF THEM.

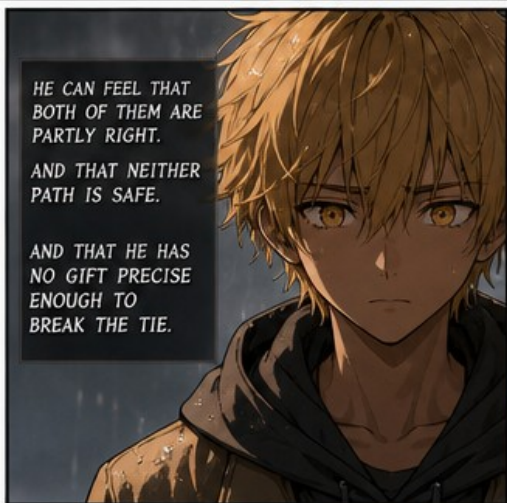
DRAWN BY HIS OWN DREAD'S
MULTIPLYING UNRESOLVABLE
PATHS FROM THE PREVIOUS DAY.



HE CAN FEEL THAT
BOTH OF THEM ARE
PARTLY RIGHT.

AND THAT NEITHER
PATH IS SAFE.

AND THAT HE HAS
NO GIFT PRECISE
ENOUGH TO
BREAK THE TIE.



RATHER THAN SPEAKING,
RATHER THAN CHOOSING
A SIDE,

HE TAKES ONE
STEP BACKWARD,
THEN ANOTHER.

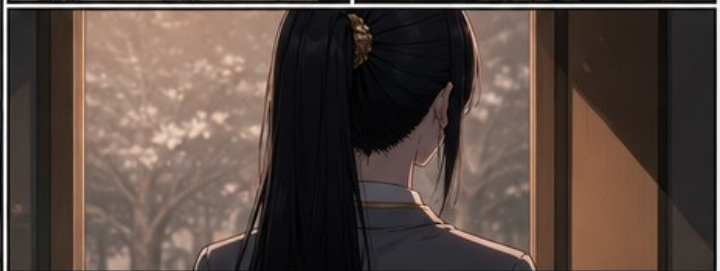
THE RAIN AT
THE WALKWAY'S
OPEN EDGE
BEGINNING TO
CATCH HIS
SHOULDER.



KAI AND REIKA
BOTH TURN TO
FIND HIM
ALREADY
RETREATING.

NEITHER HAVING
NOTICED HIM
WITHDRAW UNTIL
THE DISTANCE
HAD ALREADY
OPENED.





REIKA TENDO
18

CONTINUOUSLY
WATCHING
NAKAMURA-SENSEI
THROUGH THE
DOORWAY.

A SUDDEN,
SOURCELESS
RESOLVE.
TO SIMPLY
WALK IN.
SAY SOMETHING.
ANYTHING.
TRUE.

A VELETH CUT.

THE CORRIDOR'S
FLUORESCENT
LIGHT DIMMING
PRECISELY AS
HER FEET BEGIN
TO MOVE.

A COLD SETTLING
NOT AROUND HER
THIS TIME—
BUT AROUND
THE CLASSROOM
DOORWAY ITSELF.
A BARRIER
RENDERED AS
PURE ATMOSPHERIC
WRONGNESS.

HER NEXT STEP
FALTERS.

NOT FROM ANY
EXTERNAL FORCE
SHE COULD NAME.
SIMPLY A SUDDEN,
OVERWHELMING
RELUCTANCE THAT
WAS NOT PRESENT
A SECOND EARLIER.

SHE STANDS
FROZEN.
THE CLASSROOM'S
ORDINARY WARMTH
VISIBLE JUST
BEYOND A THRESHOLD
SHE CANNOT MAKE
HERSELF CROSS.

UNDERSTANDING,
WITH THE SAME COLD
CLARITY **KAMI** HAS
LEARNED THIS SEASON—

THAT SOMETHING WANTS
THIS PARTICULAR WOUND
TO STAY EXACTLY WHERE IT IS.





WHAT
WOULD YOU
DO, IF YOU WERE
ME, STANDING
WHERE I AM
NOW?

NEAR THE
TENDO FAMILY HOME
— THIS EVENING



ス...



I WAS
WHERE YOU
ARE ONCE,
AND I CHOSE
THE FAMILY.

I HAVE HAD
SIXTY YEARS TO
LEARN THAT THE
FAMILY WAS NEVER
ACTUALLY
PROTECTED.



IT ONLY
FELT THAT WAY
FOR A WHILE.



PROTECTION AND
IMPRISONMENT WEAR
IDENTICAL FACES
ACROSS GENERATIONS.

AND SOME
CHOICES LEAVE
NO HOME LEFT
TO RETURN TO.

1

Not a vision.

Not tonight.

Just
the weight
of choosing.

2

There is no path
that satisfies
everyone.

Not Grandmother.

Not Sensei.

Not the dead.

Only the correct
thing.

And the cost
is mine either
way.

3

Not a message.
Not silence.

A record.
A correction.

No names.
Just truth.
quietly placed
where it belongs.

To: Historical Records Office
(Anonymous Submission)

Subject: Request for Correction of
Historical Record

Respected Archivists,

I am writing to request a review and
correction regarding the faculty council
photograph and accompanying records
from the year Showa 62.

It appears that one faculty member's
name was omitted in later publications.

I respectfully request that the original
record be restored to accurately reflect
all members as they were at that time.

No further details are necessary.

Sincerely,
A concerned alumnus
(Anonymous)

☆123 あ か さ ㊟
ABC た な は 空白
ま や ら

4

It will not heal
what was broken.

It will not ease
her burden.

It will not
make this right.

But it will
restore what
was erased.

That is all
I can do.

Not relief.
Responsibility.
That is the third path.

KAI MORI | 17
CLASS 2-A

IT DIDN'T TRANSFER.

THE LESSON STAYED WITH ME.

REIKA UNDERSTOOD
THAT WOULD BETTER
THAN I EVER COULD.

I PUSHED HER
TOWARD SOMETHING
I'VE ONLY
OBSERVED.

CALCULATION
FAILED.

VARIABLES
I COULDN'T
QUANTIFY.



REALIZATION:
ISOLATION BY
INTELLECT.

REIKA TENDO | 18
CLASS 3-B

THE LETTER
HAS BEEN SENT.

IT CANNOT BE
TAKEN BACK.

THE CORRECT
CHOICE IS
SOMETIMES
THE LONELIEST.

I WON'T LET
MY BURDEN
BECOME
THEIR CHAOS.



REALIZATION:
ISOLATION BY
RESPONSIBILITY.

SORA MINABE | 16
CLASS 1-C

THIS ISN'T AN ENEMY
I CAN FIGHT.

THIS IS THEM.

DRIFTING.
APART.
SLOWLY.

THE FRACTURE
ITSELF...

IT HURTS
MORE THAN
ANY BATTLE
THIS YEAR.



REALIZATION:
ISOLATION BY
EMPATHY.

I JUST
WANT
THEM
BOTH
SAFE.
TOGETHER.



VELETH CUT
EPISODE 8: CLOSING

SORA MINABE
THE FEELER

ALL DAY, EVERY
POSSIBLE OUTCOME.
NONE OF THEM
WERE MINE TO
CHOOSE.

THIS ISN'T
WORRY.

IT'S PREMONITION.

DREAM.
PLAN.
DO.

EXHAUSTION
THAT DOESN'T
SLEEP OFF.

THE WEIGHT OF
FUTURES THAT
HAVEN'T HAPPENED.
YET.

SO HE SET
IT DOWN.
NOT IN HOPE.
IN DEFEAT.

THE WINDOW
WAS CLOSED.
LOCKED.

THE COLD CAME
ANYWAY.

It had tried the one who saw and the one who chose.
Now it wanted the one who only felt.

THE VELETH CUT: A SYSTEMATIC CAMPAIGN AGAINST THE TRIAD



THE ONE WHO SAW
(KAI)



THE ONE WHO CHOSE
(REIKA)



THE ONE WHO FELT
(SORA)

TO BE CONTINUED...